

Medea gave Jason a bottle. “Spread this potion on your armor and it will protect you from harm,” she explained.

The next day, everyone gathered to watch Jason attempt the impossible task. Protected by Medea’s potion, however, Jason was able to approach the fire-breathing bulls without being burned, harness them, and plow the field. Next, he sprinkled the dragon’s teeth on the upturned soil. Suddenly, where the teeth had fallen, soldiers sprung from the ground!

*Where each tooth was planted, an armed soldier climbed out of the ground.*



Jason had to think—and act—quickly. He spotted a rock on the ground and flung it into the middle of the armed men. It hit one of the soldiers on the back. The soldier spun around, glared at his nearest neighbor, and drew his sword. Confused, the men attacked each other, and soon a huge fight broke out. Jason was able to cut down the remaining soldiers easily.

Aeëtes was furious. “You must have cheated!” he said. “If you want the fleece, go and get it. It is guarded by a dragon at the edge of my kingdom. Let’s see you get past that.”